

Nuran

Talk & Learn

User Manual

For parents, caregivers, and grown-ups who help

Works fully offline · No account · No ads · No tracking
Nothing she does ever leaves the iPad

Welcome

Nuran is a talking app for a child who communicates by pointing. She taps large picture buttons and the iPad speaks each word slowly and clearly. You can add her own words with your photos, put the family in with real faces and your recorded voice, and keep everything safely backed up.

Two promises shape everything in this manual:

- **She cannot break it.** Deleting is never permanent, settings live behind a grown-ups gate, and the app heals itself if the iPad misbehaves.
- **It is completely private.** No account, no internet needed, no tracking. The only way any data leaves the iPad is if you personally export a backup file.

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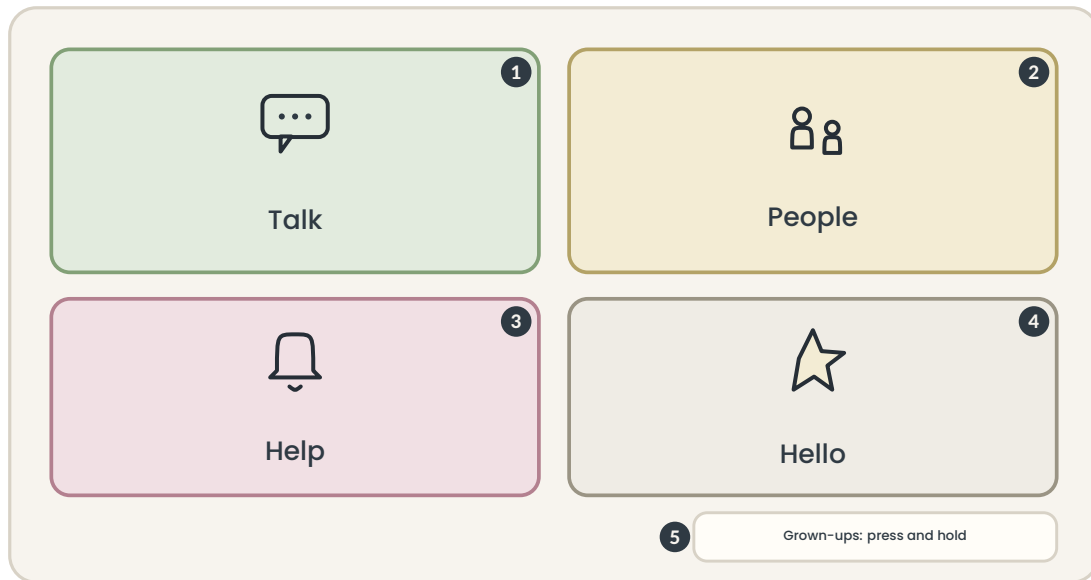
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Two-minute quick start

Open the app from its Home Screen icon, tap **Talk**, and tap any word — the iPad speaks it. That is the whole idea. Everything else in this manual just makes that richer.

1 The home screen

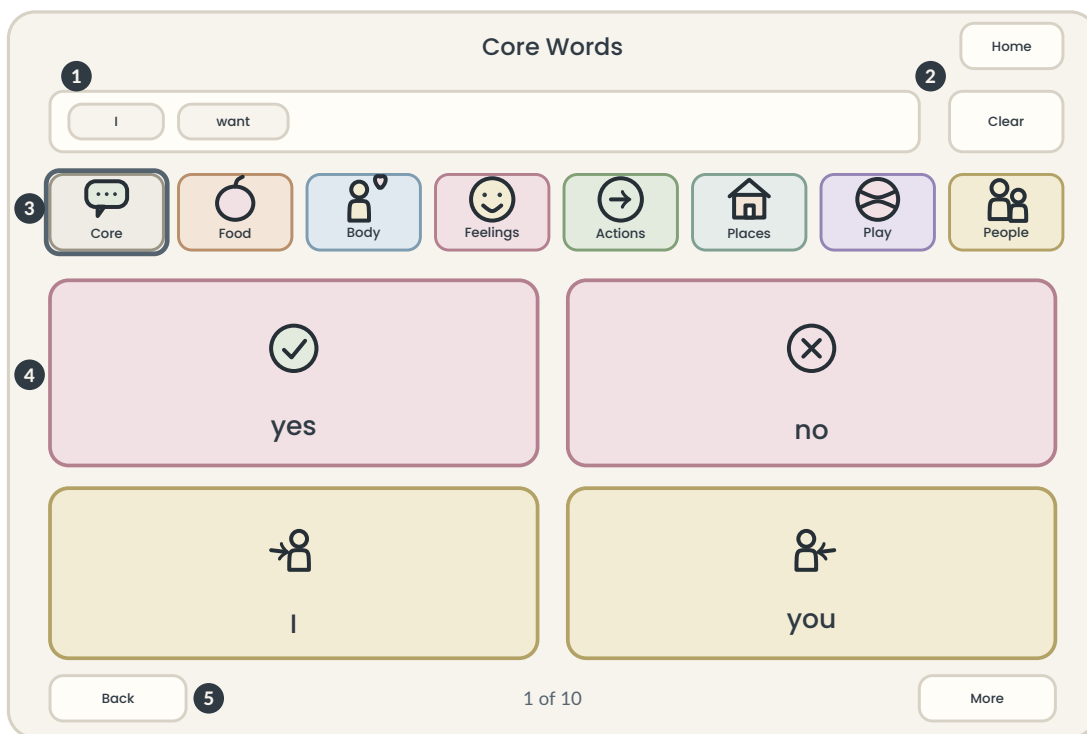
Four large buttons and nothing else. The same four things are always in the same place, which matters more than it looks: predictability is what makes the app feel safe to her.



- 1 **Talk** opens the word buttons — where she communicates and learns. (Section 2)
- 2 **People** shows family photos that speak their names when tapped. (Section 3)
- 3 **Help** rings a loud alarm so she can call a grown-up from another room. Only an adult can silence it. (Section 3)
- 4 **Hello** simply says “hello” — a safe, friendly button to experiment with.
- 5 **Grown-ups: press and hold.** Hold for about three seconds to open the caregiver area. A quick tap does nothing, so she cannot wander in by accident. (Section 4)

2 Talking: words & sentences

Tap a word, hear the word — spoken slowly, the way a speech therapist models it. Around that simple idea sit four helpers, all visible on every Talk screen:



- 1 The sentence bar.** Every tapped word also lands here, in order. Tap the bar itself and the iPad speaks the whole line — “I want cookie.” It holds up to eight words and follows her across groups, so a sentence can start in Core Words and finish in Food & Drink.
- 2 Save / Clear.** Clear empties the bar. *Holding* Save for a moment turns the sentence into a single button in a **My Phrases** group — so “I need the bathroom” becomes one tap forever after. (Holding, not tapping, so stray taps cannot create buttons.)
- 3 The group strip.** One colored button per word group; the group she is in has the darker outline. She moves between groups herself — no grown-up needed.
- 4 Word buttons.** Picture and written word together, color-coded by type: people words yellow, actions green, feelings pink. Words you add appear here too.
- 5 Back / More** turn pages when a group holds more words than one screen.

Tip

Colors are consistent everywhere: a word keeps its color across screens, so her hands learn where things are before her reading does.

3 People & the Help button

People

People shows the family as large photo tiles — real faces work far better than symbols for social words. Tapping a photo speaks the person's name, in your recorded voice if you added one, and the name joins the sentence bar just like a word: *"I want mom."* A **Back to words** button returns her to Talk. People starts empty; adding the family takes about a minute per person (Section 5).

The Help alarm

When she taps **Help**, the screen turns dark with a large "Help!" message and the iPad rings insistently — her way of calling you from another room.

- To answer it: go to her first, then **press and hold** the button on the alert screen until it releases. A quick tap will not stop it — that is deliberate.
- A small reminder banner stays on the home screen until a grown-up clears it, in case the alarm rang while nobody was nearby.
- The alarm sounds even when the app's sound setting is off.

Good to know

The alarm is loud on purpose. If it startles her the first time, practice it together once so she knows what her Help button does — and that it works.

4 The caregiver area

On the home screen, press and hold **Grown-ups: press and hold** for about three seconds. A thin line fills along the button while you hold; when it completes, the caregiver menu opens. The gate is a speed bump, not a lock — it only exists so stray taps cannot change her setup.

Menu item	What it does
Add a word	New vocabulary with a photo and optional recording. (Section 5)
Words & groups	Edit or remove words; rename, reorder, hide, or create groups.
People	Add family members, their photos, and recorded names.
Settings	Speech speed, sound, buttons per screen, sentence bar. (Section 6)
Back up	Saves everything into one file — do this weekly. (Section 7)
Restore	Rebuilds the app from a backup file or an automatic snapshot.
Recover deleted	Everything ever removed rests here; one tap brings it back.
Progress	Which words she uses most. Local only — a picture, not a report card.
Device check	Six plain-language health checks. Run it after installing.
Storage	Space used, and which photos or recordings use it.

5 Adding words & people

Adding a word — five small steps

- 1 **Open the caregiver area, tap Add a word, and type the word.**
Single words work best: *pasta*, *blanket*, *swing*. If it already exists you get a gentle warning. Interrupted halfway? Your draft is saved automatically.
- 2 **Choose its group.**
She will find it there, wearing that group's color.
- 3 **Add a photo — optional, but powerful.**
A photo of *her actual* cup beats any symbol. Snap photos with the iPad camera first, then choose them here. Without a photo the word shows as a simple letter tile.
- 4 **Record your voice — optional.**
Tap once to start, again to stop. Skip it and the iPad speaks the word by itself in the slow voice, which works fine. Family names usually sound nicer recorded.
- 5 **Tap Hear it to preview, then Save word.**
It appears in her app immediately.

Adding a person

Caregiver area → **People** → **Add a person**: name, an optional “who they are” (mom, grandma), a clear photo of their face, and optionally their name in your voice. Saved people become large photo tiles on her People screen.

Managing groups

In **Words & groups**, tap **Edit groups** to rename, reorder, hide, or add groups — *School*, *Grandma's house*. A new group appears in her strip as soon as it contains its first word.

Tip

Start small and personal. Ten words she cares about — her foods, her people, her comfort items — beat a hundred generic ones. You can always add more as she grows.

6 Settings

Everything saves instantly; there is no save button to forget. All settings live behind the grown-ups gate.

Setting	What it controls
Sentence bar	Shown (default) or hidden. Hidden means words simply speak one at a time — useful in the very beginning, or when the screen should be as simple as possible.
Keyboard	Hidden (default) or shown. When shown, a Keyboard button joins her group strip: big letter keys that speak whatever she types — her bridge to spelling. Turn it on when letters start to click.
Show	Picture and word together (default), or <i>word only</i> — switch later, when she begins recognizing written words.
Buttons per screen	4 (default), 6, 9, or 12. Start small; raise it only when she finds words easily and page-turning feels slow.
Speaking speed	Very slow → normal. <i>Slow</i> is the default and the point — resist speeding it up early. Use <i>Hear a sample</i> to compare.
Sound	On or off. Off is quiet mode for public places; words still appear visually. The Help alarm still rings — that is deliberate.
Backup reminder	How often the caregiver area nudges you to back up. Weekly is a good habit.

7 Keeping everything safe

Her vocabulary is protected three times over, and the first two layers need nothing from you:

- 1 Nothing really deletes.**
Removing a word, group, or person only hides it. **Recover deleted** → *Bring back*, and it returns exactly as it was, photo and recording included.
- 2 Automatic snapshots.**
While open, the app quietly saves a full snapshot every hour — the last 24 hours, plus one per day for two weeks. **Restore** lists them; pick a time and the app returns to exactly how it was. A safety copy is taken before every restore, so even restoring can be undone.
- 3 The backup file — the only step that is yours.**
Snapshots live on the iPad, so a lost or broken iPad takes them along. **Back up** creates one file holding every word, photo, recording, and setting, and opens the iPad share sheet — save it to iCloud Drive or Files. On any iPad, **Restore** rebuilds everything from that file. **Do it after first setup, then weekly.** It is one tap.

If the app ever opens empty

Rarely, an iPad clears storage on its own. The app notices and immediately offers its snapshots and your backup file — choose one and everything returns. You will never face a blank screen with no way forward.

8 Fixes & helping her learn

Quick fixes

If this happens	Do this
No sound when she taps	Check the iPad volume and mute switch, then Settings → Sound → On. Tap one word yourself — iPads sometimes need one tap after reopening before speech starts.
Voice sounds robotic	That is the iPad's built-in voice. Record your own for the words that matter most — recordings always win over the robot voice.
A word or group vanished	Caregiver area → Recover deleted → Bring back.
Photo would not attach	Try again or pick another photo. Camera photos and screenshots both work.
Microphone will not record	iPad Settings → Safari → allow Microphone.
Looks like a web page	It was opened in Safari instead of from its icon. Use the Home Screen icon; if there is none, redo <i>Add to Home Screen</i> .
Help alarm will not stop	Press and <i>hold</i> the button on the alert until it completes.

The one habit that matters most: model it

Children learn AAC by watching people they love use it — not by being quizzed. Use the app yourself while you speak to her: tap *more* as you offer more, tap *all done* as lunch ends, build *I want ball* in the sentence bar while saying it out loud. Follow her interests, keep it pressure-free, and let her push the buttons that matter to her. Every tap you model is a small lesson that this thing on the table is *her voice*, and that it works.

App link <https://ngev.github.io/nuran-aac/>

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